THE PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE
REGIONAL ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL GOVERNMENT
LONGIDO DISTRICT MID TERM JOINT EXAMINATION

FORM THREE
024 LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

Time: 3 Hours **Monday, 31st august 2026 p.m.**

Instructions

1. This paper consists of sections **A**, **B** and **C** with **11** questions.
2. Answer all questions in sections A and B and two questions in section C of which question 9 is compulsory.
3. Section A carries 16 marks, section B carries 54 marks and section C carries 30 marks.
4. Cellular phones and any unauthorized materials are not allowed in the examination room.
5. Write your Name on every page of your answer sheet.

SECTION A (16 MARKS)

Answer **all** questions in this section.

1. For each of the items (i - x), choose the correct answer from among the given alternatives and write its letter beside the corresponding item number in the answer sheet provided.

(i) A wise, short saying passed down through generations, often used to teach morals or give advice, is called:

A. Riddle B. Proverb C. Anecdote
D. Myth E. Legend

(ii) Juma is a literary artist who writes short, interesting accounts about a real incident or person. Such short accounts are called:

A. Fables B. Anecdotes C. Myths
D. Parables E. Legends

(iii) The following are common features of both oral and written literature EXCEPT:

A. Both use language creatively
B. Both reflect human society and experiences
C. Both are preserved mainly through memory and word of mouth
D. Both have a message for the audience
E. Both employ elements such as characters and setting

(iv) Which term is used to refer to a person who narrates stories orally, especially in traditional African societies?

A. Novelist
B. Short story writer
C. Narrator/Griot
D. Poet
E. Essayist

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(v) A character who does not change in attitude or personality throughout a story is called:

A. A dynamic character B. A round character C. A static character

D. A protagonist E. An antagonist

(vi) Neema likes composing and singing traditional songs during ceremonies in her village. In literature, Neema can best be described as:
A. A poet B. A playwright C. An oral artist
D. A novelist E. An essayist

(vii) The repetition of the same consonant sound at the beginning of neighbouring words is called:
A. Assonance B. Alliteration C. Rhyme
D. Onomatopoeia E. Repetition

(viii) A statement that exaggerates something for emphasis and is not meant to be taken literally is called:
A. Simile B. Metaphor C. Hyperbole
D. Understatement E. Irony

(ix) A literary artist who specializes in writing extended fictional prose narratives that explore human experiences through a complex plot is called:
A. A novelist
B. A traditional singer
C. An essayist
D. A biographer
E. A poet

(x) The point in a story where the conflict reaches its highest tension before resolution is called:
A. Exposition B. Climax C. Denouement
D. Rising action E. Falling action

2. Match the descriptions in **List A** with the corresponding item in **List B** by writing the letter of the correct response beside the item number in the answer sheet provided.

LIST A	LIST B
(i) Repetition of vowel sounds within nearby words	A. Setting
(ii) Traditional short stories that use animals to teach moral lessons	B. Personification
(iii) A struggle between opposing forces in a story	C. Fables
(iv) Words that imitate the sounds they describe	D. Assonance
(v) Giving human qualities to non-human or inanimate things	E. Onomatopoeia
(vi) The time and place in which a story occurs	F. Conflict
	G. Myth
	H. Simile

SECTION B (54 MARKS)

Answer **all** questions in this section.

3. Literature exists in both oral and written forms, and each form contributes to the preservation and communication of ideas in society.

(a) Distinguish between oral literature and written literature.
(b) Give two characteristics of oral literature.

(c) State two advantages of oral literature to a community.

4. Read the following poem and answer the questions that follow.

THE VENDOR'S SONG

Under the flyover, dust and noise,
I spread my mat before the sun climbs high.
Tomatoes, onions, a small change of coins,
counted twice, thrice, before I buy.
the maize flour for tonight's meal.

Cars roar past like impatient beasts.
throwing smoke into my open stall,
Nobody stops, nobody feasts.
on words I do not dare to call
across the hurrying, hungry street.

My daughter waits behind the door.
with schoolbooks she cannot yet own,
I count coins on the market floor.
and pray the profit I have grown
will pay her fees before the term.

Evening comes and folds the day.
I gather what is left unsold.
The city swallows light away.
And I walk home, tired, growing old.
counting hopes instead of gold.

Yet tomorrow, before the sun,
I will return with my mat and tray.
For this is the only race I run,
the only song I know to play,
until my daughter finds her way.
(An original composition for examination purposes)

Questions

(a) Who is the persona in this poem, and how do you know?
(b) The last stanza ends with the line "until my daughter finds her way". What does this line suggest about the persona's motivation?
(c) Identify a line with personification in the poem and explain why it is personification.
(d) Suggest three main ideas that the poet wanted to communicate to the audience.
(e) Do you think this poem is still relevant today? How?

5. Study the following statements and answer the questions that follow.

   (a) Identify the literary device used in each of the following:

   (i) *The classroom was as silent as a grave.*
   (ii) *The angry wind knocked at the windows throughout the night.*
   (iii) *Peter packed plenty of pencils in his pocket.*
   (iv) *I have told you a thousand times to respect your elders.*

   (b) Briefly explain **two differences between a simile and a metaphor**.
   (c) State **three reasons why literary devices are important in a literary work**.

6. Which literary term(s) is being described by each of the following descriptions?
   (i) This is the point after the climax where the conflict of a story is resolved and loose ends are tied up.
   (ii) After a serious road accident, Baraka only said, "It's just a small scratch," referring to his broken arm. This is an example of.....
   (iii) Before he passed away, Nelson Mandela wrote a book about his own life and struggles, entitled "Long Walk to Freedom". Such accounts are called…….
   (iv) Mr.Seypalm likes to use expressions with meanings different from those of the individual words used. These expressions are called…….
   (v) It is a kind of literature that deals with real events, facts and actual people.
   (vi) "Life is a battlefield we must all cross" …….
   (vii) "What a lovely day for a picnic!" said Halima, as the rain poured down and the wind tore the tent apart ……..
   (viii) "O sun, o sky, o boundless field of gold, thou art the promise of our harvest" …….
   (ix) "We shall never forget, we shall never surrender, we shall never give up" …….

7. Read the following oral narrative and answer the questions that follow.

   A young man once found an old man struggling to carry a heavy load. The young man laughed and continued walking. Later, the young man reached a river and discovered that the bridge had collapsed. The old man, who knew another safe path, helped him cross the river. The young man became ashamed of his earlier behaviour and asked for forgiveness.

   (a) Identify two characteristics of oral literature evident in the narrative.
   (b) What moral lesson can be learnt from the narrative?
   (c) Identify one possible audience for this narrative and explain why it would be appropriate.
   (d) State two ways through which such a narrative can be transmitted from one generation to another.

8. (a) As a literature student, concisely discuss how setting can be effective in a literary work.

(b) "Literature mirrors the society in which it is produced." Justify this statement with three points.

SECTION C (30 MARKS)

Answer only two questions from this section. Question nine is compulsory.

LIST OF READINGS

PLAYS

The Lion and the Jewel - Wole Soyinka

The Trials of Brother Jero - Wole Soyinka

The Dilemma of a Ghost - Amma Ata Aidoo

The Government Inspector - Gogol, N.

NOVELS

The Concubine - Elechi Amadi

House Boy - Ferdinand Oyono

The Old Man and the Medal - Ferdinand Oyono

A Walk in the Night and Other Stories - Laguma, A.

POETRY

Selected Poems - Tanzania Institute of Education

Growing Up with Poetry - David Rubadiri

9. Playwrights often use minor and comic characters to expose the weaknesses of society. Using two plays of your choice from the list above, prove this statement (three points from each play).

10. A play is a form of literature intended to be performed before an audience. Using two plays from the prescribed list, explain how the playwrights use dialogue, characters and setting to develop the story. Give three points from each play, ensuring that each point is supported with a relevant example.

11. Poetry communicates ideas through carefully selected words, sounds and images. Using two poems from the prescribed poetry selections, explain how the poets use any three poetic techniques to make their poems effective. Give three points from each poem, and support each point with a relevant example.